

HTML Forms

Inputs, labels, buttons, and the fundamentals of collecting user data.

1. What Is a Form?

Forms allow users to enter information and submit data. The **<form>** element provides the container for form controls.

```
<form>
  <!-- form elements go here -->
</form>
```

2. Text Input Field

Use **<input type="text">** to collect a single line of text. A **<label>** describes the input and makes the form easier to understand and use.

Element / Attribute	Purpose
	Provides a visible description for an input.
for	Connects the label to the input whose id matches it.
id	Uniquely identifies the input and is used by the label connection.
name	Identifies the field when form data is submitted.

```
<form>
  <label for="name">Name:</label>
  <input type="text" id="name" name="name">
</form>
```

3. Password Field

Use **type="password"** for password input. The browser hides the characters as the user types.

```
<label for="password">Password:</label>
<input type="password" id="password" name="password">
```

4. Submit Button

Use **type="submit"** to create a control that submits the form.

```
<input type="submit" value="Submit">
```

5. Placeholder Text

The **placeholder** attribute displays a short hint inside an input before the user enters a value.

```
<input type="text" placeholder="Enter your name">
```

Accessibility note: A placeholder is a hint and should not replace a proper label.

6. Complete Example

```
<form>
  <label for="email">Email:</label>
  <input type="email"
        id="email"
        name="email"
        placeholder="you@example.com">

  <br><br>

  <label for="pass">Password:</label>
  <input type="password"
        id="pass"
        name="pass">

  <br><br>

  <input type="submit" value="Login">
</form>
```

7. Quick Reference

Feature	HTML
Form container	
Text input	
Email input	
Password input	
Submit control	
Input hint	placeholder="..."
Label connection	for="..." + matching id
Submitted field name	name="..."

TIP — BUILD ACCESSIBLE FORMS

- Always label your inputs for better accessibility.
- Match the label's **for** value with the input's **id**.
- Use **name** attributes when the form will submit data.
- More input types will be introduced in the next lesson.

Quick Takeaway

A basic HTML form combines **<form>**, labeled inputs, appropriate input types, and a submit control. Good labels improve accessibility, while **name** identifies fields for submitted form data.